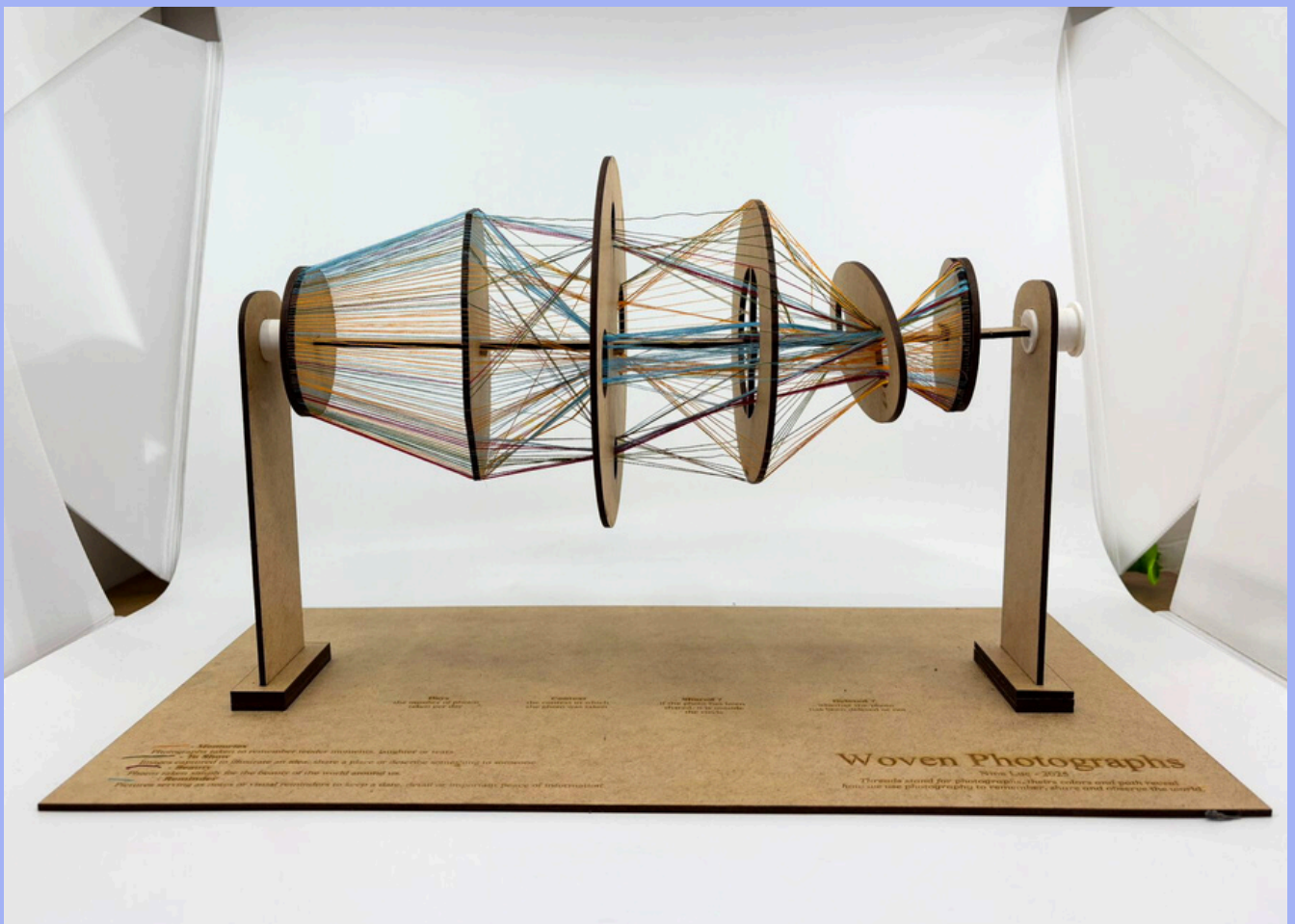


# WOVEN PHOTOGRAPHS

NINA LUC

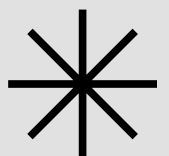


2025

# INTRODUCTION

This project explores how photography shapes and accompanies our daily lives. We take photos to remember, to share, to immortalize, or simply out of habit, sometimes without thinking, sometimes intentionally. I am interested in the space between these gestures: the difference between photographing out of necessity, for pleasure, or as an artistic act.

Starting with a database that we had to build ourselves from fragments of our daily lives, this project invited us to transform digital information into meaningful physical objects. Woven Photographs, my final physicalization, explores this transition from the digital to the tangible. This report looks back at the creative process, the formal choices, and the intentions that shaped this project.



# DATA

## WHAT IS THE DATA ABOUT ?

The data I chose to collect is related to my photography practice. For fourteen days, I noted down the number of photos taken each day, their context and the reason for taking them. I then added to this database by indicating whether I had deleted any photos or shared them. When collecting data, I also noted the subject of the photo, as well as the medium, i.e., which camera I used to take it. This data was subsequently deleted.

## WHY DID I DECIDE TO COLLECT THIS DATA?

I'm interested in exploring the way we use photography in our daily lives. I chose this data because I really like photography in general, but I also use my phone's camera a lot to take pictures of things I want to remember or show to my loved ones. I wanted to know what differentiated these photos, and the place each one occupies in my daily life.

## DATA QUESTIONS

For what purposes do I most frequently use photography ?

I am aware that I take photos very often, probably because I have a visual memory, but I didn't really know how often or why. Physicalization seemed relevant to answering this question, as it allows you to create groups and visualize the distribution of different motivations more clearly.

Are the pictures meant to last ?

At one time or another, we all experience sorting through our photo galleries and deleting numerous photos. This observation led me to question the actual proportion of these deletions and their significance: if a photo is destined to be deleted, what meaning can we attribute to the act of taking it? The aim of this visualization is to identify whether the context or initial motivation for taking the photo influences the decision to delete it.

Is the reason why I take a photo greatly influenced by its context ?

This question is more or less related to the others. The question here is whether, depending on the context, we take more or fewer photos, whether these photos will be deleted more often than photos taken in other contexts, and whether they will be shared more or less. Once again, the advantage of representing this data physically is that it facilitates the link between the context and the future of the photo.

# IDEATION

I had two ideas for how to represent this data:

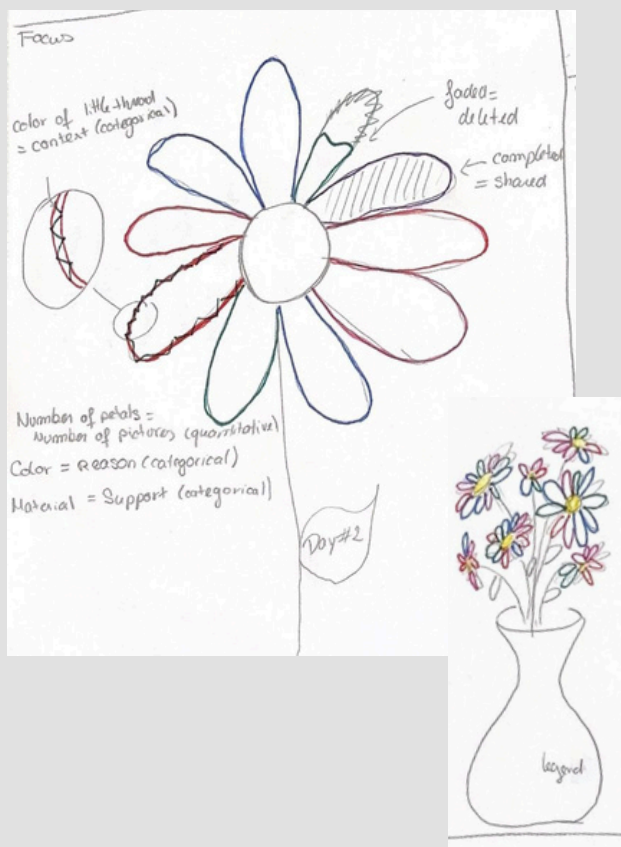
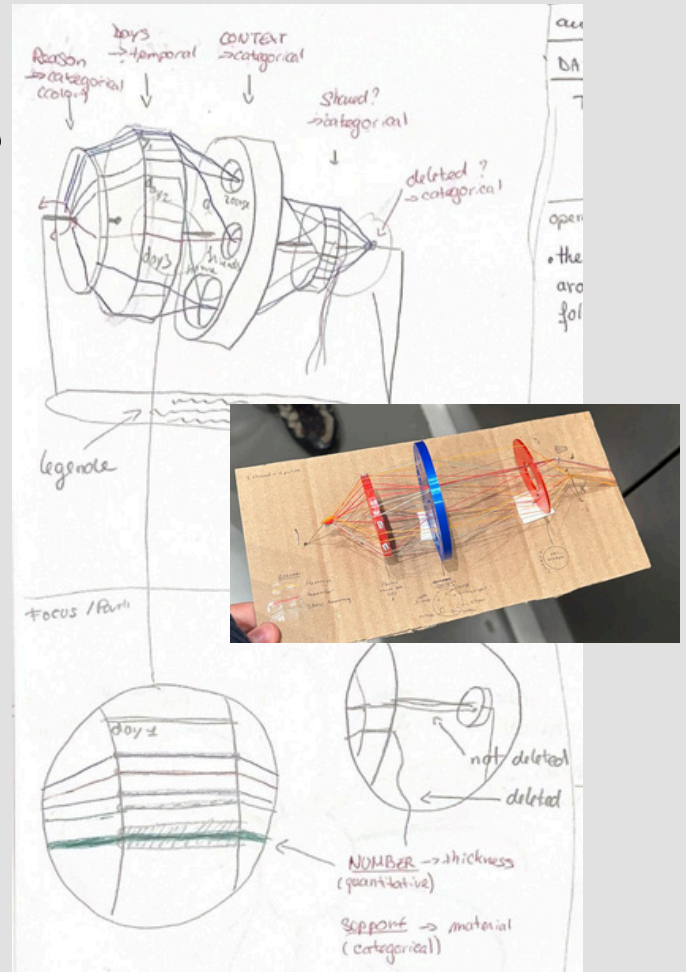
## WOWEN PHOTOGRAPHS

For this visualization project, I wanted to represent each photo/group of photos with a thread.

The color of the thread would represent the reason why the photo was taken, its thickness would represent the number of photos in the group, and its material would represent the type of medium (film camera, iPhone, or digital camera).

The threads would be placed on different wheels, each representing a category. The first wheel represents the days, the second the context, and the last whether or not the photo was shared. Depending on whether the photo was deleted or not, the thread would continue its path or not at the end.

The user can rotate the object around the metal axis to better follow each thread.



## THE BOUQUET OF MEMORIES

For this visualization, I chose to represent each day with a flower. On a flower, each petal represents a photo: the color of the petal represents the reason why the photo was taken. Small colored threads around the thread of a petal represent the context. The material used would represent the medium with which the photo was taken. If the petal is "withered," then the photo has been deleted.

The flowers would be grouped together in a vase, in a bouquet, with explanations provided.

The user is free to pick up and handle each flower as they wish.

# DESIGN CRITIQUE

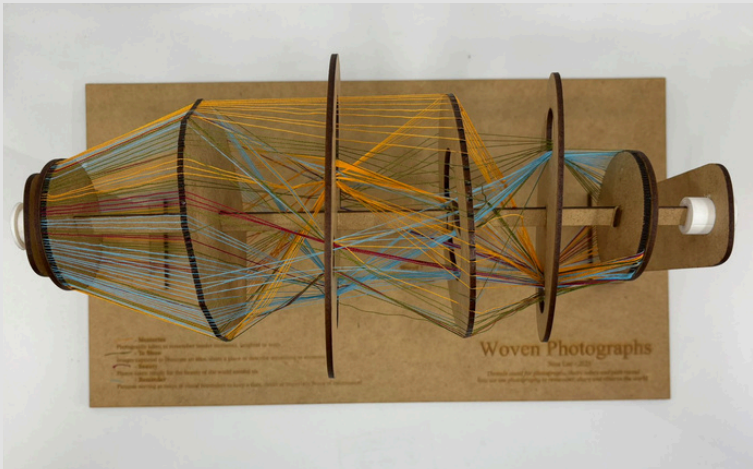
The feedback indicated that only minimal adjustments were needed. The main concern raised was related to my first visualization: I was advised that, to make the categories easier to understand, it could be more effective to use different shapes rather than multiple circles, and to pay close attention to the relative sizes of each disk.

Overall, the information appeared sufficiently clear to the reviewers.

In light of their comments, I intend to pursue my initial concept first, and, if it proves too challenging, revert to my secondary idea.



# THE FINAL PROJECT



My final project takes the form of a model in which several wooden discs are connected by colored threads that pass through them. The whole thing is mounted on a rotating support, allowing the model to be turned so that the path of each thread can be followed more easily.

## visual mapping of data attributes

### THREADS

Each thread represents a photo. Its color represents the reason why it was taken:

#### **YELLOW - MEMORIES**

Photographs taken to remember tender moments, laughter or tears

#### **GREEN - TO SHOW**

Images captured to illustrate an idea, share a place or describe something to someone.

#### **RED - BEAUTY**

Photos taken simply for the beauty of the world around us.

#### **BLUE - REMINDER**

Pictures serving as notes or visual reminders to keep a date, detail or important piece of information.

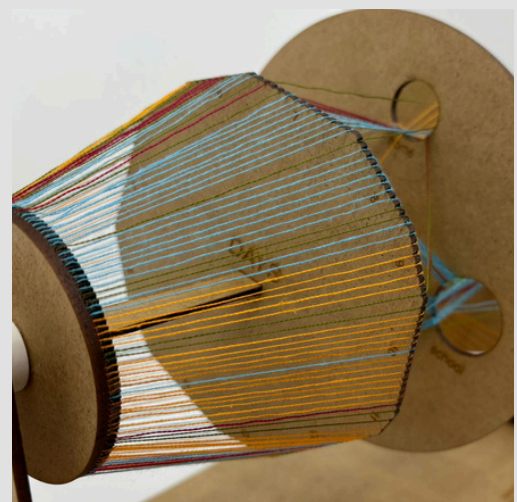
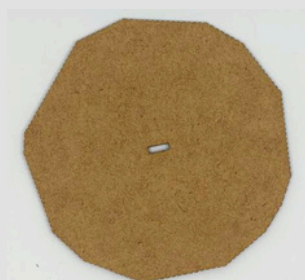
### STAGES

Each wooden disc functions as a “stage” in the reading process: it reveals a new aspect of the photo and contributes to how it is classified. Together, these steps structure and organize the data.

#### **1ST STAGE - DAYS**

The number of photos taken per day.

The first wooden piece is shaped like a 14-sided polygon. Each side corresponds to a day, with the length proportional to the number of photos taken on that day. Notches are built into the piece to allow for the insertion of wires.



# THE FINAL PROJECT

## 2ND STAGE - CONTEXT

The context in which the photo was taken.

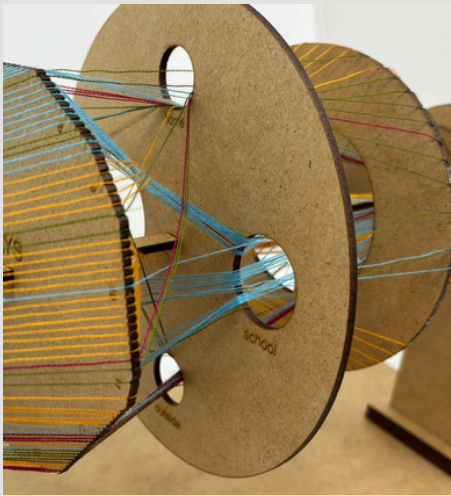
The second piece is a circle with four openings, each representing a shooting context. The four contexts chosen are:

**school:** photographs taken in one of my schools;

**outside:** photographs taken outside, away from my home;

**with friends:** photographs taken in the company of friends, whether or not they are the subject;

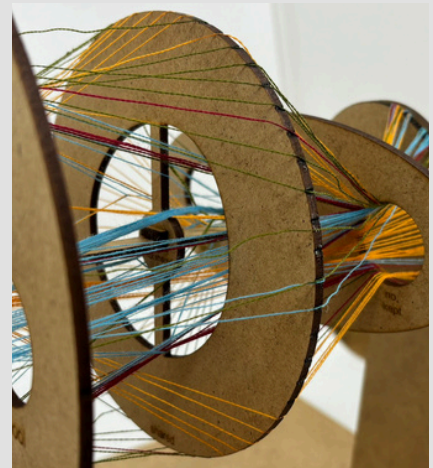
**home:** photographs taken at my home.



## 3RD STAGE - SHARED ?

If the photo has been shared, it is outside the circle.

The third piece is a circle with a single hole in the center. It is used to model the response to a closed question: was the photo shared? The threads extend outside the circle when the answer is yes, and remain tight inside the circle when the answer is no.

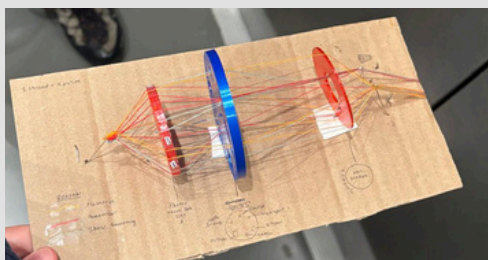


## 4TH STAGE - DELETED ?

Whether the photo has been deleted or not.

The last piece also represents the answer to a binary question: has the photo been deleted? It takes the form of an oval with two openings, one for the wires associated with deleted photos, the other for those linked to photos that have been kept.

## materials used and fabrication process

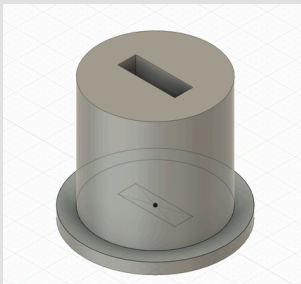
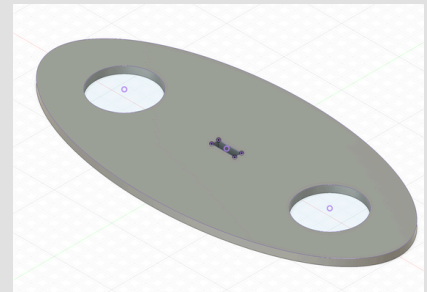
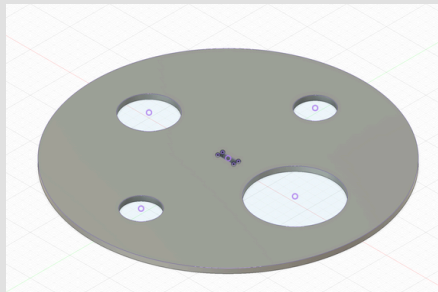
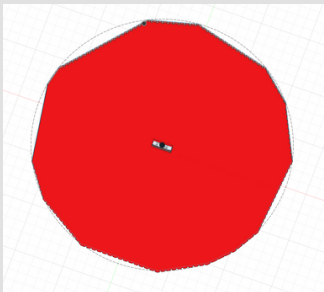
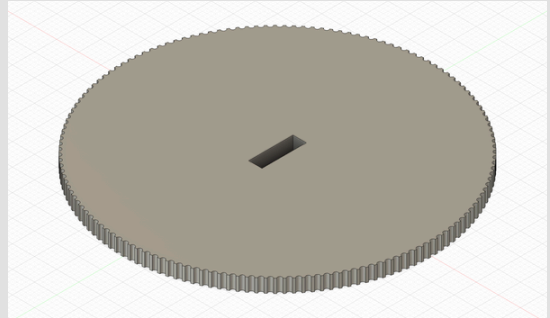


First, I made a prototype out of cardboard and 3D-printed circles. Initially, the piece for deleted didn't exist, but after making the prototype, I realized it needed to be added.

# THE FINAL PROJECT

I chose to use wood as the main material for constructing the final support, and to cut the pieces using a laser. This technique allows tests to be carried out very quickly, much faster than 3D printing, which often takes several hours, while offering a visual and tactile finish that better matches the spirit of the project.

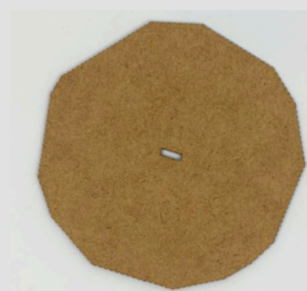
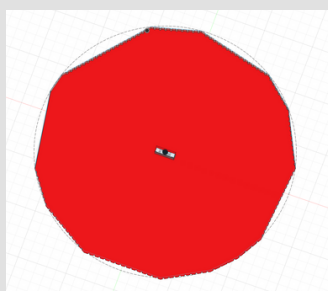
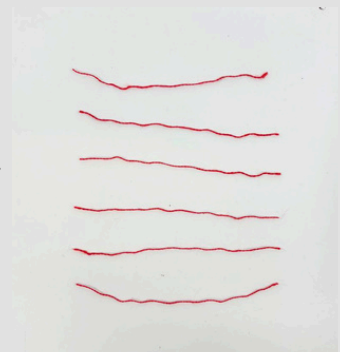
First, I modeled all the parts in 3D on Fusion before cutting and engraving them. I created the four parts corresponding to the different “stages” of visualization, as well as the elements needed to stretch and hold the threads: two discs placed on either side of the threads: two discs placed on either side of the structure, one of which has 145 notches.



Each disc also has a central rectangular notch that allows it to be fitted onto the device's rotating axis.

The structure itself consists of a large rectangular bar and two small 3D-printed supports inserted into two wider side bars. This assembly creates a suspension effect that allows the model to rotate freely.

For the threads, I used cords commonly used to make friendship bracelets. Each thread was divided into six thinner strands. In total, I divided 26 threads, which I then attached one by one to the model, following the data from the base precisely.



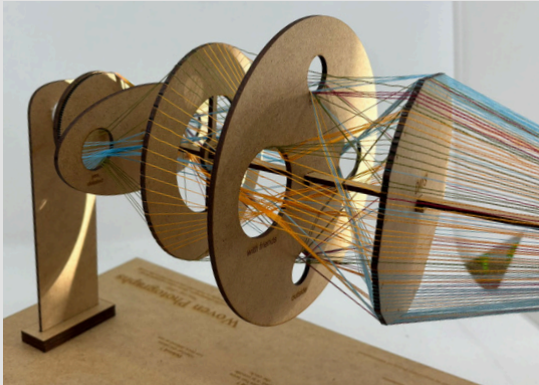


# THE FINAL PROJECT

## reflections on the final design

The final design effectively answers the questions raised earlier. The goal was not to display each photo individually, but to visualize the entire corpus as a whole. At each stage of the process, patterns emerge and groupings form naturally, revealing trends in my photographic practice.

### FIRST STAGE — TIME (14 DAYS)



This stage provides an overview of the volume of photos taken each day. We can see that I generally take between 5 and 10 photos per day. Two categories clearly dominate: reminders and memories. This directly answers the first question:

**“For what purposes do I most frequently use photography?”**

The answer is clear: mainly for the memories and to keep a record.

### STEP TWO — CONTEXT

This step reveals the relationship between the context in which the photo was taken and the reason why it was taken. A pattern immediately emerges:

- At school, almost all photos are reminders.
- With friends, most photos are memories.
- Outdoors, they are mainly to show or taken for their aesthetic value.
- At home, there are few photos, divided into different categories except for memories.

These observations answer the question:

**“Is the reason why I take a photo greatly influenced by its context?”**

The answer seems to be yes : context strongly influences the intention of the photo.

### STEP THREE — SHARING

This step indicates whether or not a photo has been shared. We can see that the most frequently shared photos belong to the categories “memories” and “to show.” The mock-up also clearly shows that almost all of the shared ‘memories’ photos were taken “with friends.”

### FINAL STEP — DELETION

This section allows us to see which photos have been deleted. The deleted photos mainly belong to the categories “to show” and “reminder.” This step answers the question:

**“Are the pictures meant to last?”**

The data suggests that they are: the majority of photos are kept. Of those that are deleted, about half had been shared previously, which gives meaning to these images: they are not meant to last, but to be shared and then disappear.



| Date and Hour         | Subject                           | use            | How Many | context        | shared?          | Ephemere/Deleted |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------|----------|----------------|------------------|------------------|
| 16/09 - 11h16         | Tableau de cours                  | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | YES              |
| 16/09 - 12h30         | playlist in the Phone of a friend | Remember       |          | 2 with friends | no               | not yet          |
| 16/09 - 14H12         | Maquette made in a course         | Remember       |          | 2 course       | Instagram        | yes 1/2          |
| 16/09 - 15h48         | Tableau de cours                  | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | yes              |
| 16/09 - 16h55         | Affiche                           | Remember       |          | 1 outside      | no               | yes              |
| 17/09 - 12h15         | Tableau de cours                  | Remember       |          | 7 course       | no               | not yet          |
| 17/09 - 15h30         | Food                              | Memories       |          | 1 home         | no               | not yet          |
| 17/09 - 16h13         | date of a concert in my computer  | Remember       |          | 1 home         | no               | not yet          |
| 17/09 - 16h36         | Liste de courses                  | Remember       |          | 1 home         | no               | yes              |
| 17/09 - 20h53         | food                              | Memories       |          | 1 home         | yup, irl         | not yet          |
| 18/09 - 12h18         | Aisle                             | Show something |          | 1 outside      | Whatsapp         | yes              |
| 18/09 - 14h30 - 16h45 | Friends                           | Memories       |          | 7 with friends | Whatsapp         | no               |
| 18/09 - 15H           | Friend                            | Memories       |          | 1 with friends | yes              | not yet          |
| 18/09 - 17h45         | phone of a friend, event          | Remember       |          | 1 with friends | not yet          | not yet          |
| 18/09 - 18h21         | affiche                           | Remember       |          | 1 transport    | not yet          | not yet          |
| 18/09 - 20h11         | friends - sunset                  | Memories       |          | 1 with friends | no               | not yet          |
| 18/09 - 20h30         | sunset                            | Beauty         |          | 2 outside      | instagram        | not yet          |
| 18/09 - 20h30         | Friends                           | Memories       |          | 2 with friends | yes              | not yet          |
| 19/09 - 01h18         | me at home                        | Show something |          | 1 home         | Whatsapp         | not yet          |
| 19/09 - 11h25         | tableaux                          | Show something |          | 1 home         | lmessages        | not yet          |
| 19/09 - 11h30         | Paper                             | Remember       |          | 1 home         | no               | yes              |
| 19/09 - 19h15         | computer                          | Show something |          | 1 home         | imessages        | yes              |
| 20/09 - 01h48         | friend and i with text            | Show something |          | 3 with friends | Snapshat         | no               |
| 20/09 - 14h15         | Armoire- décoration               | Show something |          | 1 home         | no               | not yet          |
| 21/09 - 01h01         | friends                           | Memories       |          | 3 with friends | no               | not yet          |
| 21/09 - 12h15         | object                            | Show something |          | 2 outside      | Whatsapp         | yes 1/2          |
| 21/09 - 17h52         | Dog                               | Beauty         |          | 3 home         | no               | no               |
| 21/09 - 17h52         | sppider                           | Show something |          | 1 home         | Whatsapp         | yes              |
| 22/09 - 9H30          | Tableau cours                     | Remember       |          | 3 course       | no               | yes              |
| 22/09 - 11h30         | place                             | Show something |          | 1 with friends | Whatsapp         | yes              |
| 22/09 - 13h14         | place                             | Beauty         |          | 1 course       | no               | no               |
| 22/09 - 13h25         | panneau                           | Show something |          | 1 course       | lmessage         | yes              |
| 22/09 - 14->18        | Course tableau                    | Remember       |          | 4 course       | no               | yes              |
| 22/09 - 19h28         | my hand                           | Remember       |          | 1 home         | no               | yes              |
| 22/09 - 19h56         | meal                              | Remember       |          | 1 home         | no               | no               |
| 22/09 - 23h04         | cinema sceance on computer        | Remember       |          | 1 home         | no               | yes              |
| 22/09 - 23h08         | cinema sceance on computer        | Remember       |          | 1 home         | no               | no               |
| 23/09 - 08h31         | time schedule                     | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | no               |
| 23/09 - 12h15         | bugs                              | Show something |          | 1 home         | Whatsapp         | no               |
| 23/09 - 16h           | tableau cours                     | Remember       |          | 7 course       | no               | yes              |
| 23/09 - 16h54         | something in my pocket            | Show something |          | 1 outside      | imessages        | no               |
| 23/09 - 20h38         | message                           | Show something |          | 1 home         | imessages        | yes              |
| 24/09 - 15h25         | tableau cours                     | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | no               |
| 24/09 - 16h46         | numero bureau - computer          | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | yes              |
| 24/09 - 20h20         | meal                              | Memories       |          | 1 with friends | Whatsapp         | no               |
| 24/09 - 20h21         | friends selfie                    | Memories       |          | 4 with friends | Whatsapp         | no               |
| 25/09 - 12h38         | scenario                          | Show something |          | 1 home         | Whatsapp         | no               |
| 25/09 - 15h53         | friend                            | Show something |          | 1 with friends | imessages        | no               |
| 25/09 - 16h34         | Friend and i                      | Memories       |          | 5 with friends | instagram + imes | no               |
| 25/09 - 17h29         | tableau                           | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | no               |
| 25/09 - 18h26         | friends                           | Memories       |          | 2 with friends | Whatsapp         | no               |
| 25/09 - 21h33         | friends and i                     | Memories       |          | 5 with friends | Whatsapp         | no               |
| 25/09 - 21h36         | wall                              | Beauty         |          | 1 home         | snapchat         | no               |
| 26/09 - 13h53         | decoration                        | Show something |          | 1 home         | imessages        | no               |
| 26/09 - 14h51         | decoration                        | Show something |          | 1 home         | snapchat         | no               |
| 27/09 - 00h20         | friends                           | Memories       |          | 6 with friends | no               | yes 2/6          |
| 27/09 - 00h32         | metro pub concert                 | Remember       |          | 1 transport    | no               | no               |
| 27/09 - 11h50         | metro pub exposition              | Remember       |          | 1 transport    | no               | no               |
| 27/09 - 13h           | ultimate players                  | Beauty         |          | 3 outside      | no               | no               |
| 27/09 - 13h54         | meal with friend                  | Memories       |          | 1 with friends | no               | no               |
| 27/09 - 14h 42        | metro pub exposition              | Remember       |          | 1 transport    | no               | no               |
| 27/09 - 15h27         | lighters                          | Show something |          | 5 outside      | Whatsapp         | yes              |
| 27/09 - 22h36         | friends                           | Memories       |          | 2 with friends | no               | no               |
| 28/09 - 12h35         | brocante                          | Beauty         |          | 5 outside      | Instagram        | no               |
| 28/09 - 12h30         | brocante and friend               | Memories       |          | 3 with friends | -                | no               |
| 28/09 - 17h17         | table                             | Memories       |          | 1 home         | no               | no               |
| 29/09 - 08h55         | tableau cours                     | Remember       |          | 5 course       | no               | no               |
| 29/09 - 10h13         | Tableau Cours                     | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | no               |
| 29/09 - 12h45         | meal                              | Show something |          | 1 home         | Whatsapp         | yes              |
| 29/09 - 13h30         | friends                           | Memories       |          | 3 with friends | -                | no               |
| 29/09 - 17h07         | porte                             | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | yes              |
| 29/09 - 17h08         | affiche                           | Remember       |          | 1 course       | no               | yes              |
| 29.09 - 19h53         | firends                           | Memories       |          | 3 with friends | no               | no               |